

ISMOS

FOUNDATION

LOGO DESIGN GUIDE

V1 · 2026

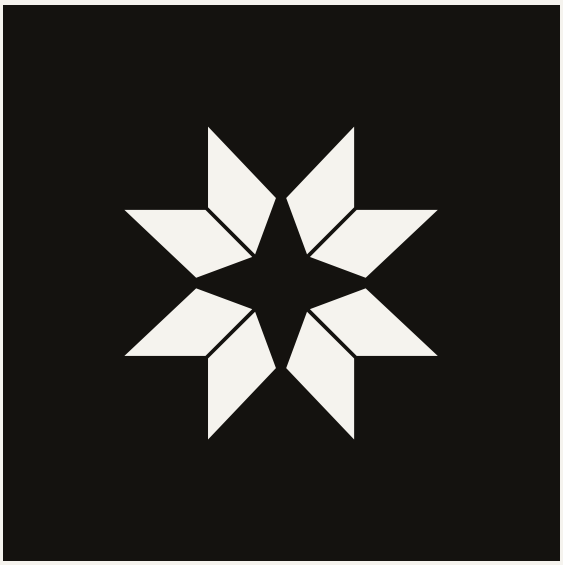
01 · ORIGIN

An eight-pointed star, stitched by hand

The mark begins with an embroidered star: eight points, arranged as four petals, each petal split down its middle into two lobes. Versions of it appear in Islamic geometric ornament, in Central and South Asian textiles, in Eastern European folk needlework, and in the quilt blocks of the Americas.

What carries across those traditions is the method rather than the motif. The star is generated, not drawn freehand: a square, its diagonals, a rotation, and a repeat. Anyone who knows the construction can rebuild it with a straight edge, which is why it travelled so far.

In the reference embroideries, the two lobes of each petal are worked in different threads. The maker is showing you that the petal is two halves meeting at a spine. That detail is the hinge the whole identity turns on.



THE ISMOS MARK. EIGHT POINTS, FOUR PETALS, EACH PETAL A PAIR OF LOBES MEETING AT A SPINE.

WHY THIS REFERENCE

A star made by construction rather than by decree suits an institution whose subject is how to think. The knowledge is portable, the method is public, and the result is the same in any hand that follows it.

PROVENANCE NOTE

The specific textiles used as reference should be credited by region and date before publication. Confirm attribution with the source before this guide is printed.

02 · MEANING

Four open books, one shared centre

Look again at a single petal and it is a book seen from above, opened flat, two pages fanning from a spine. Four petals, four books, radiating from a common centre. This reading is meant to arrive second. The star holds the silhouette; the books emerge once you have looked twice.

PILLAR 01

Financial literacy

Reading money as a system rather than a mystery.

PILLAR 02

Freedom tech

Tools that hold their promises without asking permission.

PILLAR 03

Coding and cryptography

The proofs and the practice: how to build a thing, and how to make it trustworthy.

PILLAR 04

Critical thinking

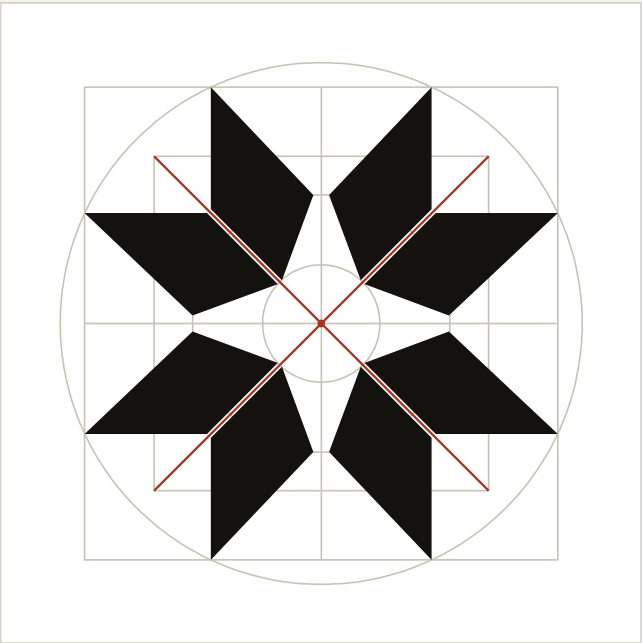
The habit of testing a claim before accepting it.



The negative space at the centre resolves into a four-point spark, the common shorthand for artificial intelligence. It is the one part of the mark that is not drawn at all. The four pillars make it by standing apart, and it binds them together: AI is the tool ISMOS builds the platform with, and the tool students are taught to learn and build with across all four subjects.

03 · CONSTRUCTION

The geometric grid



UNIT

The mark is drawn on a square of 200 units. The eight tips land on the edges of that square, four of them on its corners' axes; R110 is the circle they apex on.

AXES

Four book spines sit on the diagonals at 45°, 135°, 225° and 315°, each spine a gutter with a leaf on either side. The notches between books fall on the horizontal and vertical axes.

INNER RADII

R54 is the notch between books: the valley where two neighbouring leaves part. R25 is the reach of the centre spark, where the four tips of the negative space stop.

SYMMETRY

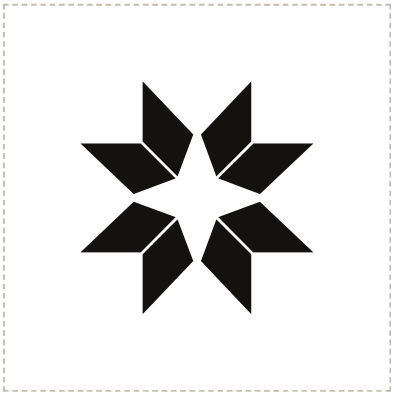
One leaf is drawn, mirrored across its spine to make a book, then rotated in 90° steps. Redrawing the mark means redrawing one shape.

How it is set

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CLEAR SPACE



One quarter of the symbol height on all four sides. Nothing enters it.

SCALE



Minimum symbol 16px on screen, 6mm in print. Minimum lockup width 120px on screen, 32mm in print.

05 · COLOUR

Black, white, and three dyes

The primary system is ink on paper and paper on ink. The three accents are drawn from the dyes those embroideries were worked in: madder, indigo, and ochre. One accent at a time, flat, never mixed inside the mark.



INK
#14120F

PAPER
#F5F3EE

MADDER
#A8341F

INDIGO
#22356B

OCHRE
#B08028

What not to do



Do not fill the centre. The spark is the mark.



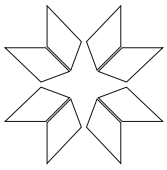
Do not rotate. The spines hold the diagonals.



Do not stretch. Scale both axes together.



Do not tint, screen back, or apply gradients.



Do not outline. The mark is solid, always.



Do not separate a book from the star or use one alone.